

Safety at work: For employees

Before ICE visits:

- Learn your rights and contact trusted immigration attorneys or organizations
- Protect your privacy by sharing your immigration status only when legally required, including for Form I-9. You choose which acceptable I-9 documents to present; your employer generally cannot require a specific document or immigration status
- Do not share your immigration status unnecessarily to protect your privacy
- Keep contact information for a trusted immigration lawyer or legal organization
- Give your employer contact information to a friend or relative and permission to give paychecks and other compensation to that person in case your employer cannot contact you

When ICE visits:

- Stay calm; do not run, physically resist, or interfere with officers
- Immediately contact the designated supervisor
- You have the right to remain silent. If ICE approaches you, you may say: "I do not want to answer questions. Please speak with my supervisor or attorney"
- Do not consent to a search or give permission for ICE to enter private workplace areas. Immediately notify your designated supervisor. Your employer should request and review any warrant
- Do not sign any documents, provide false documents or consent to searches without consulting a lawyer
- If it is safe and lawful to do so, you may observe and document the event, including officers' names, badge numbers, and actions. Do not physically interfere with officers or obstruct their work
- You have the right to report workplace violations (wage theft, unsafe conditions, discrimination) without fear of deportation or immigration-based retaliation
- Contact a trusted community organization or immigration attorney immediately

After ICE visits:

- You have the right to seek immediate legal help if you or others were detained
- Contact trusted community organizations or immigration attorneys promptly
- You have the right to file complaints with labor agencies if workplace rights were violated
- You have the right to continue documenting any workplace changes such as termination, reduced hours, or harassment
- Apply for unemployment benefits if you lose your job through no fault of your own

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Resources

- **Immigration Legal Service Coalition of San Diego: (858) 751-7553**
 - Rapid response legal support for community members detained by immigration enforcement agents
- **San Diego County Immigrant Legal Defense Program: (619) 446-2883**
 - Connects people in deportation proceedings to a free attorney. Available for people who are detained or in "alternative to detention" status in San Diego County or have ties to San Diego County. Number for people detained at Otay Mesa Detention Center: 1157# (free to dial)
- **San Diego Immigrant Rights Consortium/Alliance San Diego: (619) 269-1823**
 - Provides services including education on different forms of relief, one-on-one consultations, deportation defense, and application assistance